

12 Aug 2026 12:45:21 ET | 17 pages

Kingboard Laminates Holdings (1888.HK)

Time to Revisit After Severe Stock Correction but Accelerated Earnings Growth in 2H26E

CITI'S TAKE

We see 3 positive catalysts for KBL based on **1)** likely CCL ASP inflation by 10-15% this month after recent cost inflation of e-glass fabric since early Aug, **2)** market to shift focus on faster earnings growth outlook in 2H vs 1H after upcoming results briefing on 24 Aug, **3)** KBL to launch a new line of T-glass fabric in Aug. In view of the 1H26 results alert miss and increasing market concerns over AI capex growth on lack of FCF among major AI hyperscalers and circular financing from NVDA, we revise down our 2026-28E earnings estimates by 9-14% and TP to HK\$92 based on 22x PE at +1.5SD to mean. With the stock down >60% from its all-time high in June, we think now is a good time to revisit KBL on expected earnings growth acceleration to 2.8x yoy in 2H26E vs 2.0x in 1H26E. **Buy/1H.**

Citi-hosted first leg of investor meetings – We will host the first post-results virtual investor meetings with a group Zoom call on **26 Aug at 9.30am**. Click [here](#) for registration.

Anticipating CCL price inflation in Aug – Per F139, the ASP of e-glass fabric rose 17-18% to Rmb13.1/m on 1080 series, Rmb 12.7/m on 2116 series and Rmb10.1/m on 7628 series for Aug-26. The absolute ASP inflation of Rmb1.5-2.0/m is the largest jump during YTD. See **Fig 5** for details. Backed by the industry norm of cost-push strategy, most CCL players are likely to begin another wave of price inflation. We expect KBL to announce a 10-15% rise in CCL ASP for August from current spot price of Rmb230-250/sheet (incl VAT). This should be a near-term positive catalyst as market expectation is now low after a >60% stock correction from its all-time high in June. See **Fig 3** showing CCL ASP almost doubling this year in our model.

Acceleration of earnings growth during 2H26E versus 1H26E – **Fig 2** shows the interim results trend for 1H26E and 2H26E. We expect the interim earnings growth to accelerate to 2.8X yoy to HK\$5.726bn during 2H26E vs 2.0X to HK\$2.808bn in 1H26. (*Continued ...*)

Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (HK\$M)	Diluted EPS (HK\$)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	1,349	0.43	36.1	80.9	7.1	8.9	0.9
2025A	2,494	0.80	84.8	43.8	6.7	15.7	1.1
2026E	8,463	2.71	239.3	12.9	5.4	46.3	4.3
2027E	13,031	4.17	54.0	8.4	4.1	56.0	6.3
2028E	16,743	5.36	28.5	6.5	3.2	55.7	8.6

Source: Powered by dataCentral

Buy / High Risk from Buy

Price (11 Aug 26 16:10)	HK\$34.96
Target price	HK\$92.00↓ from HK\$130.00
Expected share price return	163.2%
Expected dividend yield	4.3%
Expected total return	167.4%
Market Cap	HK\$110,175M US\$14,041M

Price Performance (RIC: 1888.HK, BB: 1888 HK)



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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

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1888.HK: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: HK\$34.96; TP: HK\$92.00; Market Cap: HK\$110,175m; Recomm: Buy/High Risk					
Profit & Loss (HK\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	18,541	20,400	37,174	54,271	66,578	PE (x)	80.9	43.8	12.9	8.4	6.5
Cost of sales	-15,263	-16,409	-24,026	-33,625	-39,899	PB (x)	7.1	6.7	5.4	4.1	3.2
Gross profit	3,278	3,991	13,147	20,647	26,680	EV/EBITDA (x)	36.0	30.1	9.3	5.9	4.4
Gross Margin (%)	17.7	19.6	35.4	38.0	40.1	FCF yield (%)	1.6	0.2	6.2	6.5	12.4
EBITDA (Adj)	3,062	3,656	11,791	18,456	24,048	Dividend yield (%)	0.9	1.1	4.3	6.3	8.6
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	16.5	17.9	31.7	34.0	36.1	Payout ratio (%)	74	50	55	53	56
Depreciation	-886	-886	-957	-1,352	-1,700	ROE (%)	8.8	15.4	46.7	56.0	55.7
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	Cashflow (HK\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	2,176	2,769	10,834	17,104	22,347	EBITDA	3,062	3,656	11,791	18,456	24,048
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	11.7	13.6	29.1	31.5	33.6	Working capital	-138	-2,061	286	-4,429	-2,304
Net interest	-255	-161	-189	-181	-173	Other	-590	-166	-2,111	-3,892	-5,433
Associates	0	0	0	0	1	Operating cashflow	2,333	1,429	9,967	10,135	16,311
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	-185	451	90	0	0	Capex	-600	-1,230	-3,200	-3,000	-2,800
Pre-tax profit	1,735	3,060	10,735	16,923	22,176	Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Tax	-405	-618	-2,201	-3,892	-5,433	Other	0	0	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	-4	0	0	0	0	Investing cashflow	-600	-1,230	-3,200	-3,000	-2,800
Reported net profit	1,326	2,442	8,534	13,031	16,743	Dividends paid	-1,934	-2,123	-4,683	-6,868	-9,366
Net Margin (%)	7.2	12.0	23.0	24.0	25.1	Financing cashflow	-1,934	-2,123	-4,683	-6,868	-9,366
Core NPAT	1,349	2,494	8,463	13,031	16,743	Net change in cash	-201	-1,924	2,084	267	4,145
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	1,733	199	6,767	7,135	13,511
Reported EPS (\$)	0.43	0.78	2.73	4.17	5.36						
Core EPS (\$)	0.43	0.80	2.71	4.17	5.36						
DPS (\$)	0.32	0.40	1.50	2.20	3.00						
CFPS (\$)	0.75	0.46	3.19	3.25	5.22						
FCFPS (\$)	0.56	0.06	2.17	2.29	4.33						
BVPS (\$)	4.92	5.23	6.47	8.44	10.80						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	3,120	3,122	3,122	3,122	3,122						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	3,120	3,122	3,122	3,122	3,122						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	10.7	10.0	82.2	46.0	22.7						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	39.5	27.3	291.2	57.9	30.7						
Core NPAT (%)	36.1	84.9	239.3	54.0	28.5						
Core EPS (%)	36.1	84.8	239.3	54.0	28.5						
Balance Sheet (HK\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	1,924	1,628	3,432	4,453	8,426						
Accounts receivables	7,038	9,079	9,820	13,190	15,612						
Inventory	2,655	2,959	4,180	5,850	6,941						
Net fixed & other tangibles	7,483	7,684	9,926	11,574	12,673						
Goodwill & intangibles	0	0	0	0	0						
Financial & other assets	4,009	4,125	4,215	4,215	4,215						
Total assets	23,110	25,475	31,573	39,282	47,868						
Accounts payable	2,314	2,660	4,085	5,054	5,847						
Short-term debt	1,663	3,552	3,552	3,552	3,552						
Long-term debt	1,615	637	637	637	637						
Provisions & other liab	2,148	2,259	3,080	3,658	4,074						
Total liabilities	7,740	9,108	11,355	12,901	14,111						
Shareholders' equity	15,342	16,342	20,193	26,355	33,731						
Minority interests	27	25	25	25	25						
Total equity	15,370	16,367	20,218	26,381	33,757						
Net debt (Adj)	1,354	2,562	757	-264	-4,236						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	8.8	15.7	3.7	-1.0	-12.5						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click [here](#).

Steeper price inflation of e-glass fabric and CCL from early 2H26 underpins faster earnings growth in 2H versus 1H – In view of the steeper ASP increase for e-glass fabric and CCL in 2Q versus 1Q, we estimate KBL's quarterly net profit run-rate jumped >80% QoQ to ~HK\$1.8bn in 2Q26E from ~HK\$1.0bn in 1Q26E. This would be in line with other CCL comps, including the 76% QoQ rise for **Shengyi** and 106% QoQ rise for **Nanya New Material**. The stronger price inflation during Jul-Aug would translate into a faster profit run-rate in 2H versus 1H too. We believe the quarterly profit run-rate should continue to rise to HK\$2.5–3.5bn in 3Q/4Q26E vs ~HK\$1.8bn in 2Q26 thanks to expectations of continued ASP increase on CCL, e-glass fabric, and copper foil amid their sustained shortage in the AI supply chain. During interim results, management should give more color about a faster growth outlook in 2H26E.

The launch of T-glass fabric this month is another potential catalyst – KBL is prioritizing 400 new looms this year from Toyota with more allocation to production of e-glass fabric versus AI-fabric; thus, the new kiln for T-glass has been deferred by two months to August. Management explained that its plan is to prioritize sufficient e-glass fabric for its core CCL business rather than AI-fabric. The GM % of e-glass fabric is higher (say 50%+ vs. AI-fabric at over 50–70%) than core CCL (~40%), but the absolute gross profit of AI-fabric business is still well below core CCL due to substantially lower price point on fabric versus CCL. Hence, we view the deferral of T-glass fabric not as a technical issue, but rather part of the strategy of maximizing profit for the group. If the T-glass fabric launch is well executed this month, this would be another milestone for KBL to directly compete with **Nittobo** for the core T-glass product. KBL will solely sell T-glass fabric to **EMC** for manufacture of substrate on smartphone and AI server, per the company.

Reasons for earnings downward revision and TP downgrade – In view of earlier 1H26 results alert miss, we reduce our 2026–28E earnings estimates by 9–14% mainly led by revenue downward revision on lower ASP assumption on CCL and GM on a possible slowing AI capex growth outlook. The details are shown in **Fig 1** below. We thus reduce our TP to HK\$92 from HK\$130 based on 22x 2027E P/E at +1.5SD over mean from prior +3SD given the growing market concerns over AI capex growth among hyperscalers due to lack of FCF and circular financing from NVDA. We maintain Buy but assign High Risk as shown in our quant model due to high stock price volatility.

Figure 1. Earnings Revision Summary for 2026–28E

	Old			New		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	40,803	58,148	76,223	37,174	54,271	66,578
Change % (New vs Old)				-9%	-7%	-13%
GM	36.3%	38.7%	40.6%	35.4%	38.0%	40.1%
Change % (New vs Old)				-0.9%	-0.6%	-0.5%
Net profit	9,607	14,275	19,522	8,534	13,031	16,742
Change % (New vs Old)				-11%	-9%	-14%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

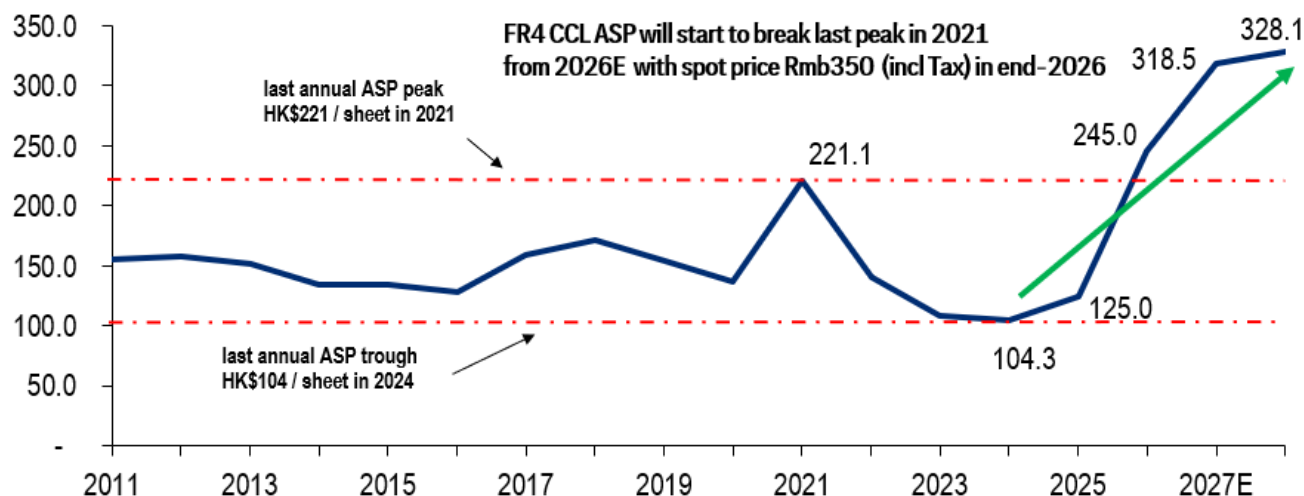
Figure 2. KBL – interim results trend with Citi forecasts of 1H26E and 2H26E

HK\$m	1H24	2H24	1H25	2H25	1H26E	2H26E
Total revenues	8,638	9,903	9,588	10,842	15,771	21,403
YoY	6.5%	14.6%	11.0%	9.5%	64.5%	97.4%
Gross profit	1,704	1,574	1,763	2,228	4,905	8,243
Other op income	49	41	34	34	37	43
Distribution cost	(224)	(212)	(231)	(247)	(407)	(536)
Admin cost	(364)	(393)	(380)	(430)	(628)	(823)
Impairment loss on investments	-	-	-	-	-	-
Share-based payments	-	-	-	-	-	-
Operating profit	1,165	1,010	1,185	1,585	3,907	6,928
Finance costs	(154)	(101)	(87)	(75)	(104)	(85)
Other non-core income/(expense)	(54)	(131)	73	378	(270)	360
Profit before tax	957	778	1,171	1,888	3,533	7,202
Income tax	(228)	(177)	(238)	(380)	(724)	(1,476)
Minority interests	(2)	(2)	(0)	0	0	-
Profit to shareholders	728	598	933	1,509	2,808	5,726
YoY	72.4%	23.3%	28.2%	152.2%	200.9%	279.5%
Recurring earnings to share	769	699	875	1,207	3,023	5,440
YoY	65.4%	36.4%	13.8%	72.5%	245.5%	350.8%
Gross margin	19.7%	15.9%	18.4%	20.5%	31.1%	38.5%
Opg margin	13.5%	10.2%	12.4%	14.6%	24.8%	32.4%
Net margin	8.4%	6.0%	9.7%	13.9%	17.8%	26.8%
Distribution cost to revenue	2.6%	2.1%	2.4%	2.3%	2.6%	2.5%
Admin cost to revenue	4.2%	4.0%	4.0%	4.0%	4.0%	3.8%
Effective tax rate	23.8%	22.8%	20.3%	20.1%	20.5%	20.5%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

Figure 3. Expectation of almost doubling ASP of FR4 CCL this year vs last year



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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

Figure 4. Surge of e-glass fabric prices YTD Aug 2026



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Source: Citi Research, F139 (subsidiary of SCI99), Company Reports

Figure 5. Highest increase of ASP inflation in Aug on e-glass fabric

Rmb / m	1080	2116	7628	Monthly ASP addition		
				1080	2116	7628
Dec-25	5.0	4.9	4.6			
Jan-26	5.7	5.5	4.8	0.7	0.6	0.2
Feb-26	6.3	6.1	5.4	0.6	0.6	0.6
Mar-26	7.1	6.8	5.9	0.8	0.7	0.5
Apr-26	8.1	7.8	6.1	1.0	1.0	0.2
May-26	8.8	8.5	6.7	0.8	0.7	0.6
Jun-26	9.8	9.4	7.4	0.9	0.9	0.7
Jul-26	11.3	10.9	8.6	1.5	1.5	1.2
Aug-26	13.3	12.7	10.1	2.0	1.9	1.5

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Source: Citi Research, F139 (subsidiary of SCI99), Company Reports

Figure 6. KBL - forward PE chart



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Figure 7. KBL - forward PE chart



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Figure 8. Surge of e-glass fabric prices YTD Aug 2026



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Companies Mentioned:

Elite Material (2383.TW; NT\$5730.0; 1; 12 Aug 26; 13:30) | Kingboard Holdings (0148.HK; HK\$46.98; 1; 12 Aug 26; 16:10) | Nanya New Material Technology Co Ltd (688519.SS; Rmb297.27; Not Rated; 12 Aug 26; 15:00) | Nitto Boseki (3110.T; ¥3050.0; 1; 12 Aug 26; 15:30) | NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O; US\$217.5; 1; 11 Aug 26; 16:00) | Shengyi Technology (600183.SS; Rmb143.23; 1; 12 Aug 26; 15:00)

Bull/Bear: Kingboard Laminates Holdings (1888.HK)

HK\$ **130.00**



▲272% Upside

HK\$ **92.00**



▲163% Upside

HK\$ **27.00**



▼23% Downside



Spread 295pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 11 Aug 2026



BULL Assumptions

Fair value is HK\$130.0 for stronger-than-expected demand and profitability of AI-related products



BASE Assumptions

TP is set at HK\$92.0 on 22x PE for 2027E backed by 3-yr EPS CAGR of 89% thru 2028E



BEAR Assumptions

Fair value is HK\$27.0 for slower-than-expected margin expansion on cost pressure

Kingboard Laminates Holdings

Company description

Kingboard Laminates (KBL) was spun off from Kingboard Chemicals in December 2006. The Kingboard Group first began laminates production in 1989, and has facilities in Guangdong and Jiangsu provinces. Laminate is the primary feedstock to produce printed circuit boards. KBL is an integrated producer with a focus on rigid laminates, which are used in a wide range of electronic products. It also produces copper foil, glass yarn and fabric, kraft bleached paper, and epoxy resin, mainly for internal use. In 2024, glass epoxy laminates and upstream materials accounted for 91% of group revenue, property sales for 1% and others for 8%. According to Prismark, a market research company, KBL has a ~15% global market share in rigid laminates, and >30% in the PRC. Kingboard Holdings owns 67% of KBL.

Investment strategy

We rate KBL shares as Buy/High Risk given the start of an earnings upcycle from 2024 after the downcycle in 2022-23. We project a three-year EPS CAGR of 89% through 2028E after 72% / 27% earnings declines in 2022 / 2023 during the last industry downcycle. The economic slowdown in China adversely impacted discretionary consumption items such as autos, home appliances, smartphones and PC/notebooks in 2022-23 which altogether account for >80% of KBL's total sales. However, KBL has started penetrating into Nvidia and ASIC chips supply chains via high-end fabric (low Dk, low CTE and Q-glass). The company's revenues and earnings are being buoyed by surging ASPs of e-glass fabric, AI fabric, and CCL that have boosted the growth trajectory.

Valuation

Our target price for KBL shares of HK\$92 is based on a ~22x P/E for 2027E, at +1.5SD over mean, which is lower than prior +3SD due to the market's increasing concerns over the sustainability of AI-infrastructure capex growth among the Magnificent 7 companies due to the lack of FCF and circular financing from NVDA. We still employ a premium (+1.5SD) over mean to reflect the growing % of its AI-fabric new business from 2H26E which should trigger re-rating along with further earnings upgrade possibility on e-glass fabric given higher run-rate of price inflation in June. We think the premium is justified as we expect a continued GM expansion cycle during 2026E-28E along with potential earnings upgrades given KBL would expand its customer base for AI-fabric under the NVDA and ASIC ecosystem this year. We think a PE methodology appropriately captures the company's medium-term operating performance. Our target price translates to 0.2-0.3x PEG (regional comp around 0.6x) backed by strong three-year earnings CAGR of 89% thru 2028E. We think this appears undemanding compared with regional CCL comps.

Risks

Our quant model gives a High Risk rating on the stock due to high stock price volatility. In terms of fundamentals, upside/downside risks that could cause the stock to exceed/underperform our target price include: 1) faster/ slower-

than-expected demand on upstream materials such as glass fabric and copper foil on AI-related products; 2) China macro growth performs faster/slower-than-expected; 3) stronger/weaker-than-expected stimulus policies in China; or 4) recovery/weakness in end-demand of electronic goods.

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Appendix A-1

ANALYST CERTIFICATION

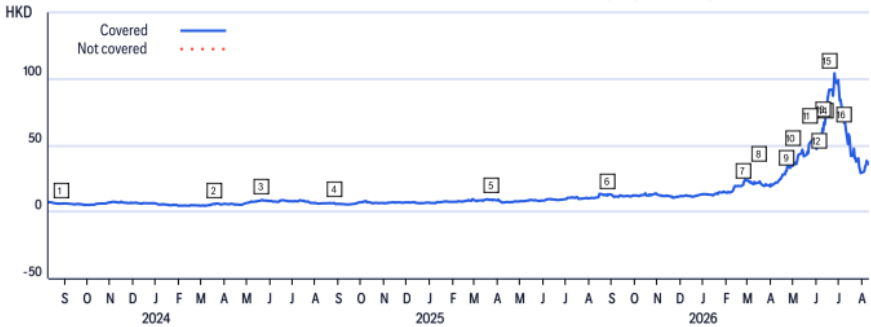
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Kingboard Laminates Holdings
(1888.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 28-Aug-23 11:03:13	1	*10.00	6.22
2 18-Mar-24 13:55:33	1	*8.20	6.00
3 20-May-24 16:10:28	1	*12.50	8.50
4 26-Aug-24 12:52:14	1	*11.50	6.67
5 24-Mar-25 13:48:33	1	*14.00	9.23
6 25-Aug-25 14:05:25	1	*20.50	12.24

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
7 23-Feb-26 11:49:32	1	*28.00	20.29
8 16-Mar-26 17:59:34	1	*30.00	22.10
9 22-Apr-26 09:32:35	1	*43.00	30.72
10 03-May-26 18:02:15	1	*51.00	34.54
11 25-May-26 19:33:53	1	*66.00	50.87
12 03-Jun-26 08:03:10	1	*76.00	54.00

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
13 08-Jun-26 10:05:51	1	*80.00	55.69
14 14-Jun-26 17:16:22	1	*100.00	65.60
15 18-Jun-26 00:33:31	1	*120.00	91.85
16 06-Jul-26 04:51:13	1	*130.00	73.85

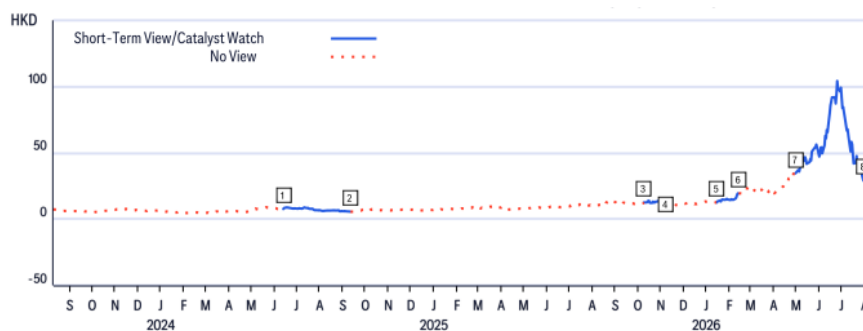
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Kingboard Laminates Holdings (1888.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	13-Jun-24 06:22:03	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	7.63
2	11-Sep-24 00:14:59	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	5.59
3	09-Oct-25 07:10:54	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.56
4	07-Nov-25 12:06:35	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	11.85
5	14-Jan-26 03:04:03	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.40
6	13-Feb-26 12:13:30	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	19.29
7	03-May-26 14:02:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	34.54
8	31-Jul-26 14:06:17	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	29.42

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

The Firm has made a market in the publicly traded equity securities of Kingboard Laminates Holdings Ltd on at least one occasion since 1 Jan 2025.

The Firm has made a market in the publicly traded equity securities of Kingboard Holdings Ltd on at least one occasion since 1 Jan 2025.

Within the past 12 months, Citigroup Global Markets Inc. or its affiliates has acted as manager or co-manager of an offering of securities of Kingboard Laminates Holdings,NVIDIA Corp.

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